

TRADEPASS ACADEMY

309A COMPANION SERIES · VOLUME 4

Exam Day Checklist

Everything to do, bring and remember for your Construction Electrician 309A sitting, from the night before to the final review pass.

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- Night-before preparation checklist
 - What to bring and what to leave home
 - A pacing plan for the full paper
 - The four-step question protocol
 - What to do when your mind goes blank

Companion resource to: Red Seal Construction Electrician 309A Exam Prep, 2026–2027 Edition

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The night before

- ☐ Lay out everything by the door: government photo ID, exam confirmation, approved calculator (with fresh batteries), pencils or pens as permitted, water and a small snack for before entry.
- ☐ Confirm the exam address, room, start time and how long the trip takes at that hour. Plan to arrive thirty minutes early.
- ☐ Read only your top-five reminders card and the memory tricks page. Nothing else.
- ☐ Set two alarms.
- ☐ Stop studying by dinner. From here, sleep outperforms any further review.

KEY POINT

Check with your provincial apprenticeship authority in advance about what is permitted in the room: calculator models, code books where applicable, and identification requirements vary. Do not discover the rules at the door.

At the centre

- ☐ Arrive early enough to sit for a few minutes and settle; rushing in raises your heart rate before the first question does.
- ☐ Use the washroom before entry.
- ☐ Turn your phone fully off and store it as directed; a buzzing phone can end an exam sitting.
- ☐ Listen to the invigilator's instructions completely, even the parts you expect.

The first five minutes

- **Skim the whole paper for thirty seconds.** Confirm the number of questions and let the shape of the exam hold no surprises.
- **Set your pace anchors.** Note the time you should pass the one-quarter, half and three-quarter marks and write them at the top of your scrap area.
- **Expect the nerves.** The first five questions feel harder than they are for everyone. Breathe out slowly and work the protocol below; your rhythm arrives by question ten.

The pacing plan

Checkpoint	Where you should be	If behind
Quarter time	About a quarter of the questions answered	Stop polishing; flag hard items faster
Half time	About half answered, flags noted	Switch to first-instinct answering on long stems
Three-quarter time	All questions seen at least once	Answer everything now; review only if time remains
Final ten minutes	Flagged questions revisited	Confirm no question is left blank

EXAM TIP

An unanswered question is a guaranteed zero; an educated guess after eliminating two options is far better than a blank. Answer everything.

The four-step question protocol

- **1. Read the stem twice.** On the second pass, underline the operative words: EXCEPT, NOT, minimum, maximum, first, line, phase.
- **2. Answer before you look.** Form your own answer, then find it among the options; distractors are weaker when you arrive with an answer.
- **3. Eliminate.** Cross out the clearly wrong options; most questions reduce to two candidates.
- **4. Commit and move.** Change an answer later only for a concrete reason — “I misread the stem,” never “it felt wrong.”

If your mind goes blank

- Put the pencil down, sit back, and take three slow breaths with a long exhale. Ten seconds spent this way buys minutes of clear thinking.
- Skip forward to any question you can answer immediately; success resets your rhythm.
- For a lost formula, write the units you need and work backwards; units rebuild formulas.
- Remember the arithmetic sanity checks: parallel resistance is smaller than the smallest branch, true power never exceeds apparent power, 600 V equipment draws less current than 208 V equipment for the same load.

After the exam

- Note, while fresh, any topics that felt underprepared — useful whether you are celebrating or rebooking.
- Results and next steps come from your provincial or territorial apprenticeship authority.
- Either way: you prepared professionally, with materials built from the same standard as the exam. **Go get your ticket.**

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